Tala De La Cruz

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Education

University of California - Berkeley *Aug 2024 – May 2026*
BA in Applied Mathematics for Financial Engineering

- GPA: 3.8
- **Coursework:** Abstract Algebra, Complex Analysis, Real Analysis, Abstract Linear Algebra, Finance, Calculus-Based Micro-economics and Macro-economics, Business Analytics, Financial and Managerial Accounting

El Camino College *Aug 2022 – Jun 2024*
AS in Mathematics, Business Administration, and Economics

- GPA: 4.0 *(Honors)*

Work Experience

Investment Research Intern *San Francisco, CA*
BAER Investment Advisory *Jun 2025 – Aug 2025*

- Conducted preliminary equity valuations using DCF and comparable company analysis
- Produced research summaries from financial statements and industry reports to inform investment outlooks

Mathematics Supplemental Instructor *Torrance, CA*
El Camino College *Aug 2023 – Jun 2024*

- Led weekly sessions for 40+ students, improving comprehension of advanced calculus concepts
- Designed worksheets and mock exams that increased student engagement and improved cohort exam scores

Professional Development

Options Strategy App Developer *Berkeley, CA*
Independent Project - GitHub *Jun 2025 – Aug 2025*

- Built an options analytics platform using self-taught Python to model options strategies (long calls/puts, straddles, covered calls/puts)
- Integrated real-time market data with Black-Scholes theoretical pricing to identify trade opportunities
- Engineered interactive 2D/3D payoff and breakeven visualizations to evaluate time decay, volatility, and stock price movements, which were then implemented in personal portfolio decisions

Director of Finance *Torrance, CA*
El Camino College Inter-Club Council (ICC) *Jun 2023 – Aug 2024*

- Managed a $65,000 budget across 50+ student organizations and led finance/budgeting workshops to increase financial literacy among students
- Founded and chaired the Finance Committee of 58 treasurers to increase financial transparency and streamline the budget-requesting process

Co-founder and Vice President *Torrance, CA*
El Camino College Business Society *Feb 2023 – Jun 2024*

- Built a network of 100+ students to provide educational and career-building opportunities
- Organized and led professional development workshops and university excursions, fostering industry exposure

Senator of Behavioral and Social Sciences *Torrance, CA*
El Camino College Associated Students Organization (ASO) *Jun 2023 – Jun 2024*

- Represented 5,000+ students by advocating for the advancement of academic, equity, and inclusion initiatives
- Mentored 2 emerging student leaders in leadership development and governance

Skills and Certifications

Certifications: FINRA Securities Industry Essentials (SIE)

Technical: Microsoft Excel (Data Analysis, Financial Modeling), LaTeX, Figma, PowerPoint

Languages: Arabic, English (Native), French (Intermediate)

Interests: Poker Theory, Trading, Chess, Sudoku, (currently learning) Python